

Cybersecurity Daily Newsletter

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Top 5 Highlights

- Arista patches VeloCloud Orchestrator zero-day exploited in attacks
- Russian hackers exploited Zimbra zero-day in espionage campaigns
- New Dysphoria DDoS botnet spreads to 200k devices worldwide
- New Certighost PoC exploit lets attackers hijack Windows domains
- Steam forums used for ClickFix cryptominer attacks

Threat Intelligence (10)

01. New Dysphoria DDoS botnet spreads to 200k devices worldwide

A botnet called Dysphoria has compromised around 200,000 devices across the world and is using them for distributed denial of service (DDoS) attacks and traffic relay operations. [...]

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/new-dysphoria-ddos-botnet-spreads-to-200k-devices-worldwide/>

02. Malvertising campaign assembles malware in browser

A large-scale malvertising campaign is using fake websites for Solana, Luno, and TradingView, employing malicious JavaScript to assemble malware directly in the user's browser.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/malvertising-campaign-assembles-malware-in-browser>

03. Phishing attacks on insurance companies evolve to real-time account hijacking

Phishing campaigns targeting financial institutions are evolving from credential harvesting for later use to real-time account hijacking, based on information published by The Hacker News.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/phishing-attacks-on-insurance-companies-evolve-to-real-time-account-hijacking>

04. AWS Shield Advanced is embracing the AWS WAF Anti-DDoS managed rule group: What changes and how to prepare

Application-layer distributed denial of service (DDoS) attacks are difficult to detect because they closely resemble legitimate traffic. HTTP request floods are now among the most common vectors targeting web applications, using valid-looking requests that blend in with normal user activity. In June 2025, AWS launched the AWS WAF Anti-DDoS managed rule group...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/security/aws-shield-advanced-is-embracing-the-aws-waf-anti-ddos-managed-rule-group-what-changes-and-how-to-prepare/>

05. New GitHub, PyPI Policies Boost Supply Chain Security

Dependabot gets a three-day cooldown window before opening pull requests, and PyPI rejects file uploads to releases older than 14 days. The post New GitHub, PyPI Policies Boost Supply Chain Security appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Audit build pipelines, rotate CI/CD secrets, enforce package integrity controls, and review developer workstation hardening.

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/new-github-pypi-policies-boost-supply-chain-security/>

06. Google changes how it names cyber threat actors

Google Threat Intelligence Group (GTIG) has started using a new naming system for the threat actors it tracks. The change comes after Mandiant and Google's Threat Analysis Group (TAG) merged into one unit, leaving the company with two separate naming schemes built up over years. Previously, Mandiant and Google's Threat Analysis Group maintained separate nam...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/07/27/google-threat-actors-naming-system/>

07. MedusaHVNC Malware Uses Hidden Windows Desktops to Evade Detection

The malware-as-a-service operation launches legitimate browsers on an invisible desktop, giving attackers persistent and covert remote access to compromised Windows systems. The post MedusaHVNC Malware Uses Hidden Windows Desktops to Evade Detection appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/medusahvnc-malware-uses-hidden-windows-desktops-to-evade-detection/>

08. Operation BlueDash Deploys Level RMM and ScreenConnect via Fake Teams Update

Cybersecurity researchers have flagged a Microsoft Teams-themed phishing campaign that employs "secure document" lures to deliver legitimate remote monitoring and management (RMM) tools. "The victim was directed through compromised web

infrastructure to a counterfeit Microsoft Store page claiming that Microsoft Teams had to be updated before the shared docu...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/07/operation-bluedash-deploys-level-rmm.html>

09. SourTrade Malvertising Campaign Secretly Builds Malware in the Browser
Impersonating well-known cryptocurrency and trading sites, SourTrade has developed a novel technique to drop infostealers to victims

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/malvertising-builds-malware-in/>

10. Cruciferra Crypter Uses BYOVD and Process Ghosting to Hide Windows Malware

The China-linked cybercrime group behind the use of income tax-related phishing lures targeting Indian taxpayers, tax professionals, and corporate finance teams has been observed using a sophisticated crypter service called Cruciferra. According to a new analysis by Proofpoint, Cruciferra has been utilized by various unrelated cybercriminal threat clusters...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/07/cruciferra-crypter-uses-byovd-and.html>

Latest Vulnerabilities (10)

01. Arista patches VeloCloud Orchestrator zero-day exploited in attacks

Arista has patched a maximum-severity command injection vulnerability in on-premises VeloCloud Orchestrator deployments that is being actively exploited in attacks. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/arista-patches-velocloud-orchestrator-zero-day-exploited-in-attacks/>

02. Russian hackers exploited Zimbra zero-day in espionage campaigns

Russian state-sponsored cybercriminals exploited a zero-day vulnerability in the Zimbra email and collaboration platform to conduct espionage against Western targets, primarily military and government agencies, according to a recent report by Tech Radar.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.scworld.com/brief/russian-hackers-exploited-zimbra-zero-day-in-espionage-campaigns>

03. New Certighost PoC exploit lets attackers hijack Windows domains

A proof-of-concept exploit for "Certighost," a Windows Active Directory Certificate Services vulnerability, has been released that can allow authenticated attackers to potentially compromise a Windows domain. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/new-certighost-poc-exploit-lets-attackers-hijack-windows-domains/>

04. Steam forums used for ClickFix cryptominer attacks

In a report by Bleeping Computer, threat actors are exploiting Steam discussion forums to distribute cryptominers through a social engineering tactic known as ClickFix.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/steam-forums-used-for-clickfix-cryptominer-attacks>

05. The enduring mystery of hacker Phineas Fisher

As outlined in TechCrunch, the enigmatic hacker known as Phineas Fisher remains one of the most elusive and impactful figures in cybersecurity, a decade after their most notorious exploits.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/the-enduring-mystery-of-hacker-phineas-fisher>

06. FBI: Breaking Affiliate Trust Sped Along LockBit's Takedown

An FBI agent explains how the multinational law-enforcement Operation Cronos was successful in disrupting the largest ransomware group of its time.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.darkreading.com/cybersecurity-operations/fbi-breaking-affiliate-trust-lockbit-takedown>

07. OnTrac parcel delivery company reports customer data breach

Bleeping Computer reports that the parcel delivery company OnTrac has experienced a data breach, potentially exposing customer personal details following a cyberattack on its corporate network.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/ontrac-parcel-delivery-company-reports-customer-data-breach>

08. Microsoft unveils MAI-Cyber-1-Flash, promises cybersecurity AI at half the cost

Microsoft has introduced MAI-Cyber-1-Flash, a security-focused AI model built into MDASH, the company's multi-agent vulnerability identification and remediation system. MAI-Cyber-1-Flash is Microsoft's first model built specifically for cybersecurity work, and the company stated that it went through review by its AI Red Team, adversarial testing, and an ass...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/07/27/microsoft-mai-cyber-1-flash-ai-model/>

09. NVIDIA Forms 37-Member Open Secure AI Alliance and Open-Sources NOOA Framework

NVIDIA and 36 other organizations have formed the Open Secure AI Alliance to develop and share open technologies, techniques, and tools for securing software and artificial intelligence (AI) agents. The 37-member group spans cloud, security, enterprise software, and AI companies, including Microsoft, Cisco, Cloudflare, CrowdStrike, Hugging Face, IBM, Palo A...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/07/nvidia-forms-37-member-open-secure-ai.html>

10. Dysphoria IoT Botnet Adds Blockchain C2 and Victim Relays After JackSkid Disruption

Dysphoria, an Internet of Things (IoT) botnet line tracked by CNCERT and XLab, has adopted blockchain-based name services and infected-device relays after a March law-enforcement operation against JackSkid infrastructure. The researchers say the design makes the botnet harder to disrupt. CNCERT, China's national computer emergency response team, and XLab, t...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/07/dysphoria-iot-botnet-adds-blockchain-c2.html>

Data Breach & Cybercrime (10)

01. Scammers impersonate ShinyHunters in new sextortion email campaign

Following insights from Bleeping Computer, threat actors are leveraging email addresses exposed in data breaches, previously leaked by the ShinyHunters extortion group, to perpetrate a new sextortion email campaign demanding \$2,000 in Bitcoin.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources:

<https://www.scworld.com/brief/scammers-impersonate-shinyhunters-in-new-sextortion-email-campaign>

02. Pope's prayer app leaks 700,000 user emails

The Click To Pray app, endorsed by the Pope and used by hundreds of thousands worldwide, was leaking user names and email addresses for months.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/popes-prayer-app-leaks-700000-user-emails>

03. Aftercall ads are driving Android users crazy

A newly uncovered ad fraud campaign is spreading Android apps that display full-screen ads every time you end a phone call.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources:

<https://www.malwarebytes.com/blog/news/2026/07/aftercall-ads-are-driving-android-users-crazy>

04. Apple sued over fake App Store crypto wallet app stealing \$1.8M in Bitcoin

Apple is being sued by three people who claim approximately \$1.8 million in Bitcoin was stolen after downloading and using a fraudulent Sparrow Wallet application from the App Store. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/apple/apple-sued-over-fake-app-store-crypto-wallet-app-stealing-18m-in-bitcoin/>

05. 27th July - Threat Intelligence Report

For the latest discoveries in cyber research for the week of 27th July, please download our Threat Intelligence Bulletin. TOP ATTACKS AND BREACHES Nichirei, a Japan-based frozen-food supplier and logistics company, has experienced a ransomware attack that disrupted shipping operations and affected approximately 5,000 customers. KFC Japan warned of possible...

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://research.checkpoint.com/2026/27th-july-threat-intelligence-report/>

06. Coca-Cola confirms data theft in Fairlife ransomware attack

The Coca-Cola Company has confirmed that hackers stole data from its dairy subsidiary, Fairlife, during a ransomware attack earlier this month. [...]

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/coca-cola-confirms-data-theft-in-fairlife-ransomware-attack/>

07. Ernst & Young data breach claimed by ShinyHunters extortion gang

The ShinyHunters extortion gang has claimed responsibility for a recently disclosed Ernst & Young data breach, saying it obtained credentials for some of the company's systems via a supply-chain attack. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/ernst-and-young-data-breach-claimed-by-shinyhunters-extortion-gang/>

08. Sextortion scammers are exploiting ShinyHunters data leaks

Scammers are posing as ShinyHunters and using leaked email addresses to make their sextortion emails seem more credible.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.malwarebytes.com/blog/scams/2026/07/sextortion-scammers-are-exploiting-shinyhunters-data-leaks>

09. The Sub-10-Minute Cloud Takeover: How Exposed IAM Keys, Misconfiguration and AI Are Rewriting the Rules of Cloud Breaches

Key Takeaways Two real-world cloud attacks reached meaningful impact in less than ten minutes despite pursuing entirely different objectives. Both attackers treated the environment as a connected system, using existing permissions and relationships to expand their reach. Reconnaissance increasingly focuses on understanding access and capability rather than...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://blog.qualys.com/product-tech/2026/07/27/the-sub-10-minute-cloud-takeover-how-exposed-iam-keys-misconfiguration-and-ai-are-rewriting-the-rules-of-cloud-breaches>

10. What's your data worth on the dark web? (Lock and Code S07E15)

This week on the Lock and Code podcast, we discuss just exactly why it is that hackers and scammers want your data-and how you're at risk.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.malwarebytes.com/blog/podcast/2026/07/whats-your-data-worth-on-the-dark-web-lock-and-code-s07e15>